



B2 · UPPER-INTERMEDIATE · ÜNİTE 9



# Psychology & Behaviour

Gramer: Hedging Language and Epistemic Modality

Ad Soyad: \_\_\_\_\_

Sınıf / Tarih: \_\_\_\_\_

Puan: \_\_\_\_\_ / 15

Psikoloji ve davranış temasıyla It appears that, evidence suggests, tends to, is likely to gibi temkinli ve akademik iddia kurma yapılarını öğreniyorsun.

1 · Kelimeler

2 · Gramer

3 · Okuma

4 · Alıştırmalar

5 · Yazma

Cevap anahtarı

## 1 Vocabulary · Kelimeler

| #  | WORD / CHUNK               | TÜRKÇE AÇIKLAMA                                |
|----|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | It appears that...         | Görünüşe bakılırsa... (moderate hedging)       |
| 2  | Evidence suggests...       | Kanıtlar göstermektedir ki... (hedged claim)   |
| 3  | It is possible that...     | Mümkündür ki... (weak hedging)                 |
| 4  | tends to                   | Genellikle ...e meyillidir (habitual tendency) |
| 5  | it could be argued that    | Savunulabilir ki... (distancing from claim)    |
| 6  | be likely to               | ...e muhtemel (probability)                    |
| 7  | presumably                 | Büyük olasılıkla, tahmin edildiğine göre       |
| 8  | to some extent             | Belirli bir ölçüde — partial truth             |
| 9  | it remains unclear whether | ...belirsizliğini korumaktadır                 |
| 10 | cognitive bias             | Bilişsel önyargı — düşünce hataları            |

## 2 Grammar · Gramer

### Hedging Language — Belirsizlik & İhtimal

**Hedging**, akademik ve profesyonel dilde kesin olmayan ifadeler kullanmaktır. "Bu kesinlikle doğrudur" yerine "Bu muhtemelen doğru görünüyor" demek — daha akademik ve güvenilir bir ton sağlar.

#### Hedging yapıları

| Yapı             | Güç          | Örnek                                  |
|------------------|--------------|----------------------------------------|
| It seems that... | zayıf tahmin | It seems that unemployment is falling. |

| Yapı                               | Güç            | Örnek                                                |
|------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>It appears that...</b>          | zayıf tahmin   | <b>It appears that</b> the policy has failed.        |
| <b>It is likely that...</b>        | orta ihtimal   | <b>It is likely that</b> prices will rise.           |
| <b>It is possible that...</b>      | zayıf ihtimal  | <b>It is possible that</b> new evidence will emerge. |
| <b>X seems/appears to...</b>       | gözleme dayalı | The treatment <b>seems to</b> work effectively.      |
| <b>X tends to...</b>               | genel eğilim   | Prices <b>tend to</b> rise in winter.                |
| <b>X is thought/believed to...</b> | genel kanı     | Exercise <b>is believed to</b> reduce anxiety.       |
| <b>suggest / indicate</b>          | veri yorumu    | The data <b>suggests</b> a correlation.              |



#### REAL ENGLISH — Akademik yazıda

Güçlü ama tehlikeli: "This proves that X causes Y."

Akademik ve doğru: "The evidence *suggests* that X *may* contribute to Y."

Kesin olmayan dil kullanmak zayıflık değil — akademik dürüstlüktür. IELTS ve CAE writing'de hedge kullanmak seni daha yüksek band score'a taşır.

### 3 Reading · Okuma

#### Why We Make Irrational Decisions

It **has long been established** that human decision-making is not purely rational. Evidence **suggests** that we are influenced by cognitive biases that operate largely below the level of conscious awareness — systematic errors in thinking that **appear** to be hardwired into human cognition.

It **appears** that the way a choice is framed — rather than its objective content — **can significantly alter** our decision. People **tend** to respond differently to "a 90% survival rate" than to "a 10% mortality rate," even though these are logically identical. This phenomenon, known as the framing effect, was described by Amos Tversky and Daniel Kahneman in 1981 and **has been replicated** in many studies since.

It **is possible** that evolutionary pressures have embedded certain irrational tendencies into our cognitive architecture. Loss aversion — the tendency to weigh losses more heavily than equivalent gains — **may be** among the most powerful and well-documented of these biases.

**It could be argued** that simply knowing about our biases **might** help us make better decisions. However, there **is some evidence** that awareness alone **is rarely sufficient**. **Presumably**, breaking deeply ingrained cognitive habits requires deliberate practice over time.

To a certain extent, these findings challenge the classical economic assumption of the "rational actor." It remains unclear whether better institutional design could compensate for individual cognitive limitations — a question that continues to occupy researchers across psychology, economics, and neuroscience.

İ Gerçek olay ve araştırmalara dayanır; ders amacıyla sadeleştirilmiştir.

**Kaynaklar:**

• Tversky & Kahneman (1981), Science — The framing of decisions — <https://www.science.org/doi/10.1126/science.7455683>

## Comprehension Questions

1. What is the 'framing effect'?

2. What is loss aversion?

3. Does awareness of biases help us overcome them, according to the text?

4. Find 4 hedging expressions in the text and classify each as strong/moderate/weak/distancing.

## 4 Exercises · Alıştırmalar

Doğru seçeneği işaretleyin.

1. \_\_\_ that stress significantly increases the risk of heart disease.  
 (a) It is obvious (b) We know for certain  
 (c) Evidence suggests
2. Exercise \_\_\_ improve mental health in some individuals.  
 (a) definitely (b) obviously (c) may
3. \_\_\_ that genetics play a significant role, but the extent is still debated.  
 (a) It is certain (b) Everyone knows  
 (c) It appears
4. The results are \_\_\_ to be affected by sample size.  
 (a) obviously (b) likely to be (c) certainly
5. \_\_\_ that other, unmeasured variables could explain these findings.  
 (a) It is certain (b) It is possible  
 (c) Research proves
6. This result \_\_\_ be the most important finding of the decade.  
 (a) obviously (b) definitely (c) could
7. \_\_\_ that social media use is linked to reduced attention spans.  
 (a) It is proven (b) There is some evidence  
 (c) Research concludes
8. The data are \_\_\_ influenced by the conditions of the experiment.  
 (a) certainly (b) obviously (c) likely to be
9. \_\_\_ that we are all unconsciously biased to some degree.  
 (a) It is certain (b) It could be argued  
 (c) It proves
10. The exact cause \_\_\_ unclear, but stress appears to be a major factor.  
 (a) remains (b) is obviously (c) is definitely
11. This pattern \_\_\_ to be more common in urban environments.  
 (a) tends (b) is (c) definitely is
12. \_\_\_ all individuals are susceptible, but the degree varies significantly.  
 (a) It is proven that (b) It is assumed that  
 (c) It is certain that

13. Regular mindfulness practice \_\_\_\_ reduce cortisol levels in some studies.

- (a) definitely (b) obviously (c) appears to

14. \_\_\_\_ whether this effect generalises across all age groups.

- (a) It is certain (b) Research proves  
(c) It remains unclear

15. There \_\_\_\_ a relationship between sleep quality and cognitive performance.

- (a) is obviously (b) is certainly  
(c) appears to be

## 5 Writing · Yazma

### 1. Hedging dönüşümü

Rewrite these overconfident sentences using appropriate hedging:

1-) 'Social media CAUSES depression.'

2-) 'Sleep deprivation DESTROYS memory.'

3-) 'Genetics DETERMINE intelligence.'

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### 2. Akademik paragraf

Write 4–5 sentences about a psychological topic (bias, memory, decision-making, etc.) using hedging language. Aim for a mix of moderate and weak hedging.

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## Answer Key · Cevap Anahtarı

### Exercises

1. **c) Evidence suggests** — Moderate hedging — akademik, güçlü ama kesin değil → Evidence suggests that...

2. **c) may** — Weak-moderate hedging — kesin değil → may

3. **c) It appears** — Moderate hedging → It appears that...

4. **b) likely to be** — Moderate hedging → likely to be (muhtemelen)

5. **b) It is possible** — Weak hedging → It is possible that...

6. **c) could** — Hedging with modal → could (olabilir — kesin değil)

7. **b) There is some evidence** — Hedged evidence claim → There is some evidence that...

8. **c) likely to be** — Moderate hedging adverb/adjective → likely

9. **b) It could be argued** — Distancing from claim → It could be argued that...

10. **a) remains** — 'remains unclear' = belirsizliğini koruyor (academic hedging)

11. **a) tends** — 'tends to' = genellikle (moderate — not absolute)

12. **b) It is assumed that** — Hedged assumption → It is assumed that...

13. **c) appears to** — Moderate hedging → appears to (görünüşe bakılırsa)

14. **c) It remains unclear** — Uncertainty hedging → it remains unclear whether...

15. **c) appears to be** — Moderate hedging → appears to be

### Comprehension

1. The tendency to respond differently to the same information depending on how it is presented (e.g. '90% survival' vs '10% mortality').
2. The tendency to weigh losses more heavily than equivalent gains.
3. Not necessarily — there is evidence that awareness alone is rarely sufficient; it may require deliberate practice.
4. e.g. 'has long been established' (strong) / 'appears' (moderate) / 'is possible' (weak) / 'it could be argued' (distancing)

### Writing — örnek cevaplar

#### Görev 1 — Hedging dönüşümü

Social media use has long been associated with increased rates of anxiety among young people. It appears that excessive use may worsen existing depression symptoms, though the causal relationship remains contested. It is entirely possible that the relationship between social media and mental health is considerably more complex than previously assumed. It could be argued, however, that social media also provides important community support for isolated individuals who might otherwise have none.

#### Görev 2 — Akademik paragraf

Sleep deprivation appears to impair memory consolidation quite significantly, according to current research. It has been suggested by several major studies that even mild, chronic sleep loss may meaningfully affect cognitive performance. It is plausible that different individuals are affected to varying degrees depending on their neurology. It seems highly likely that maintaining consistent sleep patterns would produce measurable improvements in academic outcomes.

İnteraktif sürüm, anında geri bildirim ve XP için: [abonlinenglish.school/ingilizce-b2/unite-9-hedging-language](https://abonlinenglish.school/ingilizce-b2/unite-9-hedging-language)